NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 1 • 1558–1569

Queen, Government and Religion, 1558–69



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: Queen Elizabeth I in Coronation Robes (c. 1600) **NPG 2607 • NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON**

EXAM FOCUS **Q1(a) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q1(b) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q2 Causation:** 12m [18 min] **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE SPECIFICATION FRAMEWORK • KEY TOPIC 1

4 MODULAR ENQUIRIES

TOPIC 1.1 • THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION

- Elizabethan England in 1558: society and government.
- The Virgin Queen: the problem of her legitimacy, gender, marriage. Her character and strengths.
- Challenges at home and from abroad: financial weaknesses, religious divisions, the French threat.

TOPIC 1.2 • THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION

- Elizabeth's religious settlement (1559): its features and impact.
- The Church of England: its role in society.

TOPIC 1.3 • CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT

- The nature and extent of the Puritan challenge.
- The nature and extent of the Catholic challenge, including the role of the nobility, Papacy and foreign powers.

TOPIC 1.4 • THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS

- Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne.
- Relations between Elizabeth and Mary, 1568–69.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 NOV 1558 • Accession of Elizabeth I & Council Appointments

Key Topic 1.1

Mary I dies; 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds to the throne. She immediately appoints trusted Protestant statesman Sir William Cecil as her Principal Secretary, confronting £300,000 in Crown debts and French military forces stationed in Scotland.

MAY 1559 • The Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity (The Settlement)

Key Topic 1.2

Parliament passes the Religious Settlement. The Act of Supremacy establishes Elizabeth as 'Supreme Governor' of the Church of England; the Act of Uniformity mandates the 1559 Book of Common Prayer and imposes a 1 shilling fine for recusancy.

SUMMER 1559 • The Royal Injunctions & National Visitations

Key Topic 1.2

The Crown issues 57 Royal Injunctions enforcing Protestant worship. Clergy must preach royal supremacy, condemn papal authority, report recusants, and use English bibles. National visitations by 125 commissioners inspect parish compliance.

"Remember: Mary I left Elizabeth £300,000 of debt; don't leave blank lines in your exam!"

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

JULY 1560 • The Treaty of Edinburgh

Key Topic 1.1 / 1.4

French troops withdraw from Scotland after a rebellion by Protestant Scottish lords. The Treaty establishes peace and Mary, Queen of Scots gives up her claim to the English throne, though Mary refuses to formally ratify the agreement.

1566 • The Vestments Controversy & Puritan Dissent

Key Topic 1.3

Archbishop Matthew Parker issues the 'Book of Advertisements' requiring all clergy to wear the surplice and tippet. In London, 37 Puritan vicars refuse to wear Catholic-style vestments and are deprived of their livings, revealing deep Protestant divisions.

MAY 1568 • Mary Queen of Scots Flees to England

Key Topic 1.4

Following the murder of Lord Darnley and defeat at Carberry Hill, Catholic Mary Stuart flees Scotland in a fishing boat to Workington, Cumberland. Elizabeth places her under armed house arrest, triggering twenty years of Catholic conspiracy.

How dangerous was the crisis facing Elizabeth I upon her accession in 1558?

1 17 NOV 1558

Accession of Elizabeth I

- £300,000 Crown Debt
- Antwerp Loans (14% Interest)
- Cecil Appointed Principal Secretary

Why did inherited debt and foreign loans create an immediate crisis for the new Queen?

2 NOV–DEC 1558

Features of Elizabethan Government

- 19-Man Privy Council
- Monopolies & Royal Licences
- Factional Balance at Court

How did Elizabeth use patronage and factional competition to secure political control?

3 DEC 1558

Challenges of Gender & Legitimacy

- Papal Rejection of Anne Boleyn
- 1536 Succession Act Bar
- Pressure to Produce Protestant Heir

Why did challenges to Elizabeth's gender and legitimacy threaten domestic stability?

4 JAN–MAY 1559

Parliament & Local Government

- Unpaid Justices of the Peace
- Lords Lieutenant County Militias
- Taxation Granted Solely by MPs

Why was Elizabeth entirely dependent on unpaid local gentry to enforce royal authority?

5 1558–1560

Foreign Threats: France & Scotland

- Loss of Calais (January 1558)
- Mary of Guise French Troops
- Quartered English Royal Arms

Why did the Auld Alliance and the loss of Calais make England vulnerable to foreign invasion?

"Patronage: Elizabeth gave out titles and monopolies, not marks; write the detail!"

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 12

Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Her parents' marriage • Mary, Queen of Scots ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Catherine of Aragon • Anne Boleyn • Papal Annulment • 1536 Succession Act • Henry VIII • Anointed Monarch • Privy Council • William Cecil • £300,000 Debt

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"Legitimacy was questioned because of Henry VIII; your explanation must be unquestionable."

Enquiry 1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558 • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the role of the Privy Council in 1558. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the Tudor Rose crown and note Elizabeth's £300,000 inherited debt alongside William Cecil's appointment. ← **Pages 2–3**

"Grade 9 Rule: Q1 requires Feature + Detail. Name the feature, then drop the factual hammer."

Was Elizabeth's Religious Settlement a brilliant compromise or an unstable truce?

1 NOV 1558–JAN 1559

Religious Divisions in 1558

- Conservative North & Western Gentry
- Radical Returning Marian Exiles
- Marian Bishops in Lords

Why did England's geographic and political divisions make a religious settlement essential?

2 MAY 1559

The Act of Supremacy

- 'Supreme Governor' Compromise Title
- Compulsory Oath for Clergy
- All Marian Bishops Deprived

Why did Elizabeth choose the title 'Supreme Governor' instead of 'Supreme Head'?

3 MAY 1559

The Act of Uniformity

- Compulsory 1559 Prayer Book
- One-Shilling Recusancy Fine
- Deliberate Communion Ambiguity

How did the Act of Uniformity attempt to compromise between Catholic and Protestant worship?

4 SUMMER 1559

The Royal Injunctions

- Fifty-Seven Royal Directives
- English Bible in Every Church
- Pilgrimages & Fake Miracles Banned

How did the Royal Injunctions establish central royal control over local parish life?

5 1559–1560s

Enforcing the Settlement & Church Role

- 125 Visitation Commissioners
- Parish Church Court Supervision
- Four Hundred Clergy Resignations

How effectively did royal visitations and Church courts enforce conformity across England?

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"The Religious Settlement was successful in resolving religious divisions in England in 1559." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • The Act of Supremacy • The Act of Uniformity ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Supreme Governor • Book of Common Prayer • Via Media (Middle Way) • Royal Injunctions • 1 Shilling Recusancy Fine • Marian Bishops Deprived • Communion in Both Kinds • Vestments • Parish Visitations

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"Royal Injunctions: All clergy had to teach Royal Supremacy — teach the examiner your knowledge."

 Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Royal Injunctions (1559). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch the open English Book of Common Prayer and note the 1 shilling recusancy fine. ← **Pages 2–3**

Why did both Puritans and traditional Catholics challenge Elizabeth's Middle Way?

1 1559–1563

The Nature of the Puritan Challenge

- Geneva Calvinist Influence
- Demand to Abolish Holy Days
- Threat to Royal Prerogative

Why did Puritan religious demands pose a direct challenge to Elizabeth's royal authority?

2 1566

The Crucifix & Vestments Controversy

- Parker's Book of Advertisements
- White Linen Surplice Requirement
- Thirty-Seven London Priests Sacked

Why did the dispute over clergy vestments become a major test of Elizabeth's control?

3 1559–1568

The Catholic Challenge at Home

- Church Papists Attending Services
- Lax Local JPs in North
- Tolerant 'Windows Into Men's Souls'

Why was Elizabeth able to tolerate moderate Catholic non-conformity during the early 1560s?

4 1562–1568

Foreign Threats: France & The Netherlands

- French Wars of Religion (1562)
- 10,000 Spanish Troops under Alba
- Council of Troubles Brutality

Why did the arrival of Alba's Spanish army in the Netherlands alarm the English Privy Council?

5 1568–1569

Escalating Tensions: The Genoese Loan

- £85,000 Italian Bullion Storm Shelter
- Queen Claims Italian Bank Loan
- Alba Imposes English Trade Embargo

How did the seizure of the Genoese Loan push England and Spain closer to open conflict?

"Puritans hated crucifixes and vestments; examiners hate vague assertions."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) Score: / 12

Explain why Puritans challenged the Religious Settlement in the 1560s. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • The vestments controversy • The crucifix controversy *(You must also use information of your own.)*

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:
One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:
Puritan Clergy • Matthew Parker • Book of Advertisements • 37 Vicars Deprived • Surplice and Tippet • Papal Idolatry • Geneva Bible • Crucifix Symbols • Marian Exiles

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"Vestments crisis: 37 vicars suspended by Parker in 1566 proved Protestant division."

Enquiry 1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2021 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Papal Bull (Regnans in Excelsis) in 1570. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the plain Puritan surplice alongside Archbishop Parker's Book of Advertisements. ← **Pages 2–3**

Why did the arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots transform English politics into an existential crisis?

1 1560–1565 **Mary's Claim to the English Throne** • Margaret Tudor Granddaughter Lineage • Marriage to Henry Lord Darnley • Legitimate Catholic Figurehead	***Why did Mary Stuart's royal ancestry and marriage choices threaten Elizabeth's security?***
2 FEB 1567 **The Murder of Lord Darnley** • Kirk o' Field Gunpowder Explosion • Marriage to Earl of Bothwell • Scottish Protestant Rebellion	***Why did Darnley's murder and Mary's marriage to Bothwell ruin her authority in Scotland?***
3 1567–1568 **Abdication, Lochleven & Escape** • Forced Abdication for Infant James VI • Fishing Boat Crossing to Workington • Anointed Monarch Under House Arrest	***Why did Mary's unexpected arrival in England present Elizabeth with an impossible dilemma?***
4 1568–1569 **The Inquiry at York & Casket Letters** • Eight French Casket Love Letters • Refusal of Direct Cross-Examination • No Verdict Justifies Detention	***Why did Elizabeth choose an inconclusive verdict rather than declaring Mary guilty or innocent?***
5 1569 **Mary's Imprisonment in England** • Guarded by Earl of Shrewsbury • Duke of Norfolk Court Marriage Plot • Magnet for Northern Catholic Discontent	***Why did Mary Stuart's presence in England inevitably lead to armed Catholic rebellion?***

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 20

"The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the main cause of instability in England in the years 1568–69." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • Mary's claim to the throne • The Catholic nobility ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Mary Stuart • Anointed Queen • Catholic Figurehead • Casket Letters Inquiry • Workington Fishing Boat • House Arrest • Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland • Succession Crisis • Treaty of Edinburgh

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

Enquiry 1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots • Question 3 Evaluative Essay Continued

Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION FOCUS** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the Casket Letters affair (1568–69). [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch Carlisle Castle where Mary Stuart was first held under armed house arrest in 1568. ← **Pages 2–3**

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 1 ASSESSMENT & HOMEWORK RECORD

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** [ ] **PREDICTED:** [ ] **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 1

#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
1.1	ENQUIRY 1.1: THE SITUATION ON ELIZABETH'S ACCESSION, 1558 Spine Lecture Notes (p. 4): / 10	p. 5–6	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became q... [12m]	__/__	/ 12
		p. 6	**Q1(a) Feature:** the role of the Privy Council in 1558 [2m]		/ 2
		p. 6	**Q1(b) Feature:** the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558 [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 16
1.2	ENQUIRY 1.2: THE 'SETTLEMENT' OF RELIGION, 1559 Spine Lecture Notes (p. 7): / 10	p. 8–9	**Q3 Essay:** "The Religious Settlement was successful in resolving religious div... [20m]	__/__	/ 20
		p. 9	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Act of Supremacy (1559) [2m]		/ 2
		p. 9	**Q1(b) Feature:** the Royal Injunctions (1559) [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 24
1.3	ENQUIRY 1.3: CHALLENGE TO THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT Spine Lecture Notes (p. 10): / 10	p. 11–12	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Puritans challenged the Religious Settlement in the 156... [12m]	__/__	/ 12
		p. 12	**Q1(a) Feature:** the Puritan challenge to the Religious Settlement [2m]		/ 2
		p. 12	**Q1(b) Feature:** the Papal Bull (Regnans in Excelsis) in 1570 [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 16
1.4	ENQUIRY 1.4: THE PROBLEM OF MARY, QUEEN OF SCOTS Spine Lecture Notes (p. 13): / 10	p. 14–15	**Q3 Essay:** "The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the mai... [20m]	__/__	/ 20
		p. 15	**Q1(a) Feature:** Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne [2m]		/ 2
		p. 15	**Q1(b) Feature:** the Casket Letters affair (1568–69) [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 24

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ENQUIRY 1.1
The situation on Elizabeth's acces...
Elizabethan government • Monarch, Pr...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: __/__

ENQUIRY 1.2
The 'settlement' of religion, 1559
The Act of Supremacy • 1559

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: __/__

ENQUIRY 1.3
Challenge to the religious settlem...
The nature and extent of the Puritan chal...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: __/__

ENQUIRY 1.4
The problem of Mary, Queen of Sc...
Mary, Queen of Scots: claim to the Englis...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: __/__